

really be cut out is all the millions of cars that are parked inside offices and homes and at the sides of the roads, not the everyday on-road traffic.

What will happen, however, is that far fewer cars will be sold. Which means that many companies will go belly up, and a company like Google could cause such a shake up of the automobile industry, that we may only be left with a few players in the utility segment. Lamborghini and the types will surely still have the same small niche they have now, it's the Suzukis, Mazdas, Nissans and Fords of the world that really have to be scared of this future.

APPLE KEEPS THE DOCTOR AWAY

Not “an” apple, we mean the Apple – the company. OK, we're just being cute to get a good headline, but the fact is, we're already hearing a lot of talk about how Apple's Watch, and similar devices from others, can revolutionise medicine. What's really new is that you will be wearing sensors, and those sensors will output readings, that will now be shared in real-time with whoever you choose. Let's be honest, we're all a little worried about our health,

so you're not going to be averse to letting your doctor or your hospital get readings of your vital signs. If you have a pre-existing condition, you're actually going to be eager to share the data. Prevention is better than cure... we all know this.

We will cover wearables later as well, but in terms of sensors, we're thinking not just wearable, but eatable, drinkable, excretable sensors. Heck, the sensors might well be planted with the fruit and vegetables that you will later cook and eat. If science has its way, this is exactly the future we will find ourselves in.

Now if you're covered in sensors from head-to-toe, and inside-out, all that data is going to keep you healthy. There's a big difference between a doctor telling you, “Why don't you exercise, it's good for you”, and sensors inside you reporting to your smartwatch that absorbed way too much fat today, and it's already collecting and settling in your arteries. Nothing like a message that reads “Warning: Please exercise for 15 minutes, dangerous levels of plaque found headed to your heart!” to get you motivated.

Who's going to lose their jobs? Dietitians, fitness instructors, gyms, and even

the local General Practitioner. Healthier people equals less sickness, and less need for a general doctor. Maybe that headline should have read ‘Apple killed the doctor’!

SUPER SENSITIVE

That's not all that's going to be disrupted by sensors, though. Many jobs are going to be made redundant in manufacturing and agriculture because sensors will be more accurate than any human ever can. Want to know when to water the crops? Sensors will do it automatically, in fact they can make sure that every plant gets the right amount of water, let alone think in patches of farmland...

Robots already do a lot of the manufacturing for us, and that number will only go up when the same robots start getting more capabilities thanks to advanced sensing techniques. Being able to network sensors will just mean better skill and more dexterity for a robot. This will eventually result in a robot hand that's able to handle an egg far more delicately than a human hand, for example. Or a paint brush. Or when picking fruit... but more on robots later.

FASHION OR FISSION?

Disrupter: Wearables with new interfaces

Disrupted: All screens, all stores

What Year: 2025 to 2030

Yes, this category is certainly also enabled by sensors, but the reason we're listing this separately is because we feel this will usher in a new way for us to interface with technology. We really believe that the touch screen's days are numbered. Or all screens for that matter...

What happens when you start carrying your tech around with you is pretty much what the smartphone did to the PC. Turned out that most people didn't need the versatility of the PC to begin with. Not everyone is coding, or doing complex graphical work, or working on large spreadsheets that require wide-screens and keyboards. Even before the need for a full QWERTY keyboard died, the need for a mouse did, thanks to touch.

You don't even need a keyboard anymore? The little software keypad that pops up on your touchscreen is perfectly fine for most, and if you're using Swype or something similar, you know that the need to tap on specific keys to type is also dying out.

What's next?

How about not even needing a screen anymore?

As surreal as that sounds, there is tonnes of research going into new interfaces. Virtual reality is going to revolutionise the way we get entertainment, for sure, and it's coming sooner than you think. However, apart from gaming and movies and general entertainment value, we struggle to find much more use for it. Yes there will be innovative marketing

done using VR. Perhaps someday you will “experience” Digit instead of reading it, but let's be honest, good old computing is still going to need us to look at something. That's where we think someone is going to come along and disrupt augmented reality (AR), with an offering that will just make every single screen obsolete. Whether it's your computer monitor, your cellphone, or even that spanking new Apple Watch, it could all be rendered pointless with a smart contact lens, or with some huge improvements to glasses.

With companies like Magic Leap and even Microsoft with its Hololens working on some really cool glasses to make almost anything a screen and giving you the ability to interact with your hands, it looks like the future of traditional